SIM-01 Review Transmittal

Ulmo / Picket, PCK-SIM-001: Acoustic Array Modeling and Simulation Framework, Phase SIM-01

To	Author of the PCK-SIM-001 Claude Code engineering handoff
Subject	SIM-01 (array geometry and idealized acoustic performance): delivery for review
Date	2026-11-07
Repository	`keithatulmo/picket-sim`, branch `claude/beautiful-darwin-vbeoue`
Run of record	`20261107T203522Z_d64d297c_8043684` (code commit `8043684`, clean tree)
Prepared by	Claude Code (AI-generated engineering work product). It requires review by a qualified acoustic engineer before any of it is used to set requirements.
Requested action	Technical review of method, verification and conclusions; decisions on the open items in Section 6

1. What was asked and what is delivered

The handoff authorized the first increment of a reproducible modeling framework to compare candidate Picket array geometries (A0 to A4) under idealized narrowband far-field conditions from 100 Hz to 10 kHz. It asked for verification before any hardware recommendation and for an engineering assessment that stops short of selecting a design.

Delivered in this package:

Item	Location in package
This transmittal (compliance matrix, review guide, decisions requested)	`00_TRANSMITTAL.pdf`
Engineering report with assessment, comparative table, Pareto analysis, limitations	`01_SIM-01_Engineering_Report.pdf` (and `.md`)
All figures of the run of record (10)	`02_figures/`
All tables (CSV for machines, Markdown for people)	`03_tables/`
Run record: resolved configuration, hashes of every output, software versions, self-checks; run index; errata	`04_run_record/`
Verification evidence: full pytest log and JUnit XML executed at the code commit, test inventory	`05_verification/`
Plan, conventions, metric definitions, assumption register, 7 architecture decision records	`06_documentation/`
Source archive of the exact code commit, pinned dependency lock file	`07_source/`
File manifest and SHA-256 checksums	`MANIFEST.md`, `SHA256SUMS.txt`

2. Bottom line for the reviewer

1. Four elements yield at most 6.02 dB of ideal array gain against uncorrelated noise. Against diffuse noise the compact candidates give under 0.3 dB below 1 kHz (band median). The value of a 4-element array is bearing information, not gain.
2. Directional discrimination exists only above the half-power onset (median horizon steering): A1 667 Hz, A2 334 Hz, A3 633 Hz, A4 270 Hz. A0 has none at any frequency.

3. The conventional, unambiguous band is narrow: a ratio of 3.03 for the lines, 1.44 for the 2×2 square and 1.18 for A4. Spreading four elements across two or three dimensions buys geometric observability at the cost of usable bandwidth.
4. Geometric ambiguity is exact. The lines see a cone (total left/right ambiguity for horizontal targets), the horizontal square an up/down mirror, and A4 none.
5. Any non-coplanar 4-element array has exact (0 dB) grating lobes, whatever its placement. For A4 the worst case starts at 857 Hz. Irregular placement does not help at N = 4.
6. SIM-01 does not support selecting an architecture. It does support rejecting 4-element narrowband delay-and-sum as a route to wideband, unambiguous, full-azimuth bearing.

3. Compliance matrix

Status: **Met**, **Met with note**, or **Not met**. Evidence paths are relative to the package root (report sections refer to `01_SIM-01_Engineering_Report`).

3.1 Handoff steps

Step	Requirement	Status	Evidence
1	Inspect repository; decide where the package lives	Met	Repository was empty; standalone research package decided (ADR-0001). `06_documentation/SIM-01_plan.md` Section 1
1	Short plan: architecture, equations, conventions, inputs/outputs, verification, dependencies, reproducibility, limitations	Met	`06_documentation/SIM-01_plan.md` (written before implementation)
1	Record major architectural decisions before implementation	Met	`06_documentation/adr/0001` to `0007`
2	Configurable 3-D sensor coordinates; candidates A0 to A4	Met	`04_run_record/sim01_baseline.yaml`; report Section 2
2	Arbitrary coordinates for future comparisons	Met	`type: coordinates` in the configuration; tests `test_a4_coordinates_are_configurable`
2	Do not assume a line resolves 3-D direction; identify geometric ambiguities	Met	Exact rank-based classification; report Sections 3.2 and 4.4; tests `test_rank_and_ambiguity_class`, `test_line_array_cone_invariance`
3	Wavelength, wavenumber, delays, steering vectors, frequency-dependent response, DAS, normalized beampatterns	Met	`07_source` (`acoustics.py`, `beamforming.py`); report Section 3.1

Step	Requirement	Status	Evidence
3	Mainlobe and sidelobe characteristics where meaningfully defined	Met with note	Defined in the observable space and on great-circle cuts; undefined cases reported as n/a/inf with reasons (ADR-0005, `06_documentation/metrics.md`)
3	Spatial aliasing and ambiguity; sensitivity to element count, spacing, frequency	Met	Report Sections 4.4 and 4.5; `02_figures/fig04`, `fig05`, `fig08`, `fig09`
3	Configurable sound speed, 1500 m/s nominal; homogeneous medium; no ocean propagation or self-noise	Met	`physics.sound_speed_mps`; robustness at 1450 and 1550 m/s
4	Comparison across 100 Hz to 10 kHz	Met	121 log-spaced frequencies; `03_tables/summary_by_frequency.csv`
4	Frequency-dependent beampatterns; angular response and ambiguity visualizations; representative-frequency comparisons	Met	`fig02` to `fig05`; `03_tables/representative_frequencies.md`
4	Aperture and element-spacing sensitivity	Met	`fig08`, `fig09`; `03_tables/sensitivity_*`
4	Quantitative single-channel versus multichannel comparison	Met	Report Section 4.2; `03_tables/comparison.md`
4	Frequency regions where conventional resolution is limited	Met	Report Section 4.1 and `fig07` (regime map)
4	Report undefined or misleading metrics instead of forcing numbers	Met	ADR-0005; tests `test_single_hydrophone_metrics_are_undefined_not_numbers`, `test_line_array_vertical_cut_at_broadside_is_undefined`
4	Do not equate ideal beamforming gain with detection performance	Met	Stated in report Sections 0, 1 and 4.2, figure titles and table notes
5	Steering vectors against independent analytic cases	Met	`test_two_element_steering_vector_hand_computed`, `test_steering_vector_on_y_and_z_axes`, `test_far_field_limit_of_spherical_wave`, `test_time_domain_delay_matches_steering_vector`
5	Broadside and endfire behavior	Met	`test_broadside_symmetry_and_nulls`, `test_endfire_peak_null_and_broadening`
5	Linear-array symmetry and ambiguity	Met	`test_line_array_cone_invariance`, `test_line_array_left_right_and_up_down_ambiguity`

Step	Requirement	Status	Evidence
5	Effects of increasing aperture	Met	`test_aperture_increases_resolution_and_gain`, `test_increasing_frequency_narrows_the_beam`
5	Spatial aliasing for relevant frequencies and spacing	Met	`test_grating_lobe_at_half_wavelength_criterion`, `test_worst_case_aliasing_onset_line_array_independent`, `test_worst_case_aliasing_onset_square_brute_force`, `test_exact_grating_onset_lattices`, `test_any_four_noncoplanar_sensors_have_exact_grating_lobes`
5	Single hydrophone cannot discriminate direction	Met	`test_single_hydrophone_has_no_directional_discrimination`, `test_single_hydrophone_gains_are_zero`
5	Correct frequency, length, time and angular units	Met	`test_units_wavelength_wavenumber`, `test_arrival_time_sign_and_units`, `test_degrees_not_radians`, `test_unit_errors_rejected`, `test_geometry_unit_errors_rejected`
5	Consistent results under fixed configurations	Met	`test_full_pipeline_is_bitwise_reproducible` (two full runs, identical bytes), `test_metrics_depend_only_on_f_over_c`
5	Checks against incorrect normalization, angular-convention errors and plotting artifacts	Met	`test_normalization_and_bounds_all_candidates`, `test_di_closed_form_equals_sphere_quadrature`, `test_unit_vector_cardinal_directions`, `test_horizontal_cut_plot_peak_at_steering_and_no_seam`, `test_sphere_map_orientation`, `test_display_db_floor_and_normalization_guard`; run self-checks in `05_verification/self_checks.json`
5	Tests pass before output is used	Met	`05_verification/pytest_log.txt` (131 passed at code commit `8043684`); `make sim01` runs the tests first
6	Version control, dependency specification, machine-readable configuration, tests, reproduction command	Met	Git; `07_source/requirements.lock`; YAML configuration; `make sim01`
6	Saved figures and tables; experiment records with configuration, assumptions and software version	Met	`02_figures`, `03_tables`, `04_run_record/record.json`
6	Technical report	Met	`01_SIM-01_Engineering_Report.pdf`
6	Consistent axes, units, normalization and labels	Met	`plotting.py` conventions; plotting tests
6	Do not silently overwrite historical results	Met	Immutable run directories (ADR-0006); the first run is retained with an errata entry
7	Questions 1 to 6	Met	Report Sections 5.1 to 5.6
7	Comparative table; Pareto-dominated candidates on evaluated attributes only	Met	Report Section 6; `03_tables/pareto*.md`

Step	Requirement	Status	Evidence
7	Do not select a production design from idealized simulation	Met	Report Section 7 recommends what to simulate next and selects nothing

3.2 Acceptance criteria

#	Criterion	Status	Evidence
1	All five candidates simulated through the same interface	Met	One code path (`ArrayGeometry` → `PlaneWaveManifold` → DAS → metrics); `test_all_five_candidates_through_one_interface`
2	Core numerical methods pass automated verification	Met	131 tests passing; self-checks embedded in the run
3	Results reproducible from documented configurations	Met	`make sim01`; two identical end-to-end runs produce byte-identical outputs; numeric tables of the first and final runs agree (report Section 9)
4	Comparative plots and tables generated	Met	`02_figures`, `03_tables`
5	Assumptions and limitations documented	Met	`06_documentation/assumptions.md`; report Sections 1 and 8
6	Report identifies which candidates warrant further simulation	Met	Report Section 7
7	Extensible to sensor noise, propagation and host effects without rewriting the core	Met with note	Extension points in ADR-0007: manifold interface with an element-response hook, noise-coherence interface, explicit weights. Not exercised beyond SIM-01, so the claim is by design, not yet demonstrated

3.3 Engineering principles

#	Principle	How it was applied
1	First principles, established theory	Plane-wave array theory; every threshold cross-checked against closed forms (c/(Nd), c/(2d), c/(8d), Dirichlet patterns)
2	Correctness and verification over visualization	131 tests plus run self-checks; two defects found by checking were fixed before reporting (Section 5)
3	Modeled effects versus assumptions	`docs/assumptions.md` separates modeled, assumed, excluded and placeholder items
4	No fabricated results or specifications	Every number in the report comes from the run tables; the A4 coordinates are labelled a placeholder; no hardware specifications are asserted
5	Numerical and analytical baselines	Closed-form DI versus quadrature; brute-force versus algorithmic sidelobes and aliasing
6	Supports additional geometries	Arbitrary coordinates, rotation and scale in the configuration
7	Experimental code separate from production and Fathom	Standalone repository, no production imports (ADR-0001)
8	Record assumptions, decisions, configurations, results	ADRs, configuration hash, `record.json`, `RUN_INDEX.csv`, `ERRATA.md`
9	Complete, tested, documented implementation	See Sections 3.1 and 3.2
10	Say when evidence is insufficient	Report Sections 0 (item 7), 5.5, 7 and 8

4. Additions beyond the handoff (for the reviewer to accept or reject)

Addition	Why
Exact rank-based ambiguity classification and observable-space metrics	Keeps a geometric cone or mirror image from being misreported as a "0 dB sidelobe"
Worst-case aliasing onset over all steering (wavevector space) and exact grating onset (reciprocal lattice)	Steering-independent aliasing limits; revealed that A4's aliasing is structural
Regime thresholds f_HP, f_SL, f_amb	Turns "where does resolution become limited" into numbers with a closed-form check
Sound-speed mismatch bias	Q5 asks for robustness to sound speed; mismatch produced the one non-robust finding (planar elevation)
Orientation variants (vertical line, vertical square)	Shows that orientation decides which angle is lost
Pareto analysis with numerical and engineering tie tolerances, plus a leave-one-out table	Without tolerances, rounding at the 1e-16 level changed a dominance result (Section 5)

Not done, as out of scope or deferred: sensor position, gain and phase error Monte Carlo; broadband and TDOA processing; adaptive and superdirective weights; acoustic vector sensors; cylindrically isotropic and directional noise; host shading. All are listed as future work in the report.

5. Errors found and corrected during the work

Recorded in `04_run_record/ERRATA.md`. The first complete run (`20261107T200834Z_cf0574c6_059a354`) is retained unmodified in the repository. A floating-point residue (half-power sphere fraction 1 + 2e-16) combined with a Pareto comparison that had no tie tolerance made A1 appear non-dominated by A3 in one attribute set. The code was corrected (normalization by the quadrature weight sum, explicit tie tolerances) and both fixes are covered by tests. Two figure annotations were also corrected. The first complete run (`20261107T200834Z_cf0574c6_059a354`, code `059a354`) and the run of record share 26 tables. 16 are byte-identical, including the full 29,040-row sweep, all regime thresholds, the sensitivity sweeps and the robustness tables. The other 10 differ only by the added exact-grating column, the corrected Pareto result and their Markdown renderings. Every numeric value present in both runs is identical.

6. Decisions requested from the reviewer

1. **Mission band and signals.** Every SIM-01 threshold scales with array size, so aperture cannot be chosen until the band (and tonal versus broadband content) is set.
2. **Bearing requirement.** Is horizontal bearing with left/right ambiguity acceptable (lines), or is full-azimuth (planar) or 3-D (volumetric) bearing required? Can host maneuvering be assumed to resolve ambiguity?
3. **Ambiguity criterion.** SIM-01 used -3 dB (and -1 dB). A detection-oriented requirement may need -6 or -10 dB, which narrows every reported band.
4. **A4 coordinates.** Provide surveyed host positions, or accept the placeholder as a generic "distributed" case.
5. **Candidate set for SIM-02.** Recommended additions: planar arrays with 6 to 8 elements, acoustic vector sensors, and a broadband/TDOA model for distributed layouts (report Section 7).
6. **Pareto tolerances.** Confirm or replace the engineering tie tolerances in the configuration (0.05 m footprint, 0.25 dB DI, 0.02 HPSF, 5 % on frequencies).

7. Suggested review path (about 45 minutes)

1. This transmittal, Sections 2 and 6.

2. Report Section 0 (bottom line), Figure 2 (regime map) and Section 4.1.
3. Report Section 5 (assessment) and Section 6 (comparative table, Pareto).
4. Spot-check the verification: `05_verification/pytest_log.txt`, then `06_documentation/metrics.md` for definitions you may disagree with.
5. Optional: reproduce. Unpack `07_source`, install from `requirements.lock`, then run `make test` and `make sim01` (about 20 minutes on one CPU). Compare the new tables with `03_tables` using `SHA256SUMS.txt`.

Integrity: `sha256sum -c SHA256SUMS.txt` from the package root verifies every file.